

JESSICA L.S. OLSEN

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SUMMARY

Community-investment and grantmaking leader with eleven years serving California's most overburdened families. At the San Joaquin Valley Air District in Fresno, stewarded a \$140M community grant portfolio across 200+ projects, built and led the team behind it, and launched a first-of-its-kind participatory budgeting tool that put residents in the design seat.

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Builder | RegScout | <https://beyond-markets.vercel.app/> 2025–Present

Regulatory and funding intelligence for mission-driven investors and founders (beta)

- **Shipped working beta** iterating with early users across the climate and impact space

Investor | Stanford GSB Impact Fund | Stanford, CA 2025–2026

Student-led impact fund investing at the intersection of financial return and measurable social impact

- **Awarded the inaugural Kahn-Olsen Award** (named after my partner and myself) for Best Presentation

Director of Community Strategies & Resources | Valley Air District | Fresno, Ca 2021–2025

Public health agency; led \$140M portfolio and interdisciplinary, interagency team

- **Built and led new impact team** from the ground up; managed \$12M annual operating budget; served as agency spokesperson to state legislature and media
- **Owned lifecycle of \$140M capital deployment** across 200+ community projects: built performance measurement system (cost-per-ton, adoption rates, health KPIs) for allocation decisions; removed 8,000 tons of air pollution
- **Authored and won \$1M competitive EPA/IRA grant** funding for deployment of 20,000 household air purifiers through community-based organization trust networks, offsetting wildfire smoke impacts on public health
- **Shaped public policy** at local, state, and federal levels: briefed lawmakers and agency heads, negotiated impact program design and funding; key leader in gathering support for the California Pesticide Notification System
- **Designed and launched community inclusion tool** adopted by other agencies

Innovation + Collaboration Principal | Doolittle Institute | Niceville, FL 2018–2019

Nonprofit connecting government, academia, and industry for Air Force Research Lab technology transition

- **Founded Think Thursdays**, a recurring convening connecting founders, researchers, and government leaders
- **Designed and launched cross-sector innovation initiatives** reaching 650+ researchers, engineers, and military leaders

Program Manager, Air Quality Analysis, Research & Modeling | Valley Air District | Fresno, Ca 2019–2021

- **Co-led federal air quality compliance planning** for the San Joaquin Valley (population 4M+), coordinating state and federal regulators on outcomes for one of the most heavily impacted air basins in the United States
- **Led implementation of California's Community Air Protection Program** translating technical analysis into community-driven investment decisions with environmental justice partners
- **Built research partnerships** with UC Davis, Stanford, Texas A&M, and national labs to expand the District's evidence base across air quality, climate, and community health

Air Quality Analysis and Research Supervisor | Valley Air District | Fresno, Ca 2014–2018

- **Supervised team of scientists and analysts** producing the technical evidence base for air quality regulation across mobile, industrial, and community sources
- **Led technology evaluation** that drove industry-wide adoption of emissions-reduction equipment across California; demonstrated how regulator-led technical analysis can shift industry behavior at scale
- **Key strategist on federal air quality compliance planning** partnering with state and federal regulators on outcomes for 4M+ Valley residents

EDUCATION

- M.S. in Management** | Stanford Graduate School of Business 2026
Certificate: Public Management and Social Innovation
Coursework: public policy ethics, political economy, impact investing, data & decisions, strategy & marketing
- M.S. in Biomedical Engineering** | UC Irvine Henry Samueli School of Engineering 2014
- B.S. in Bioengineering** | UCLA Henry Samueli School of Engineering 2011
Two peer-reviewed publications in Biomacromolecules (co-first author, 2013)

LEADERSHIP & RECOGNITION

- **AAPCA Best Practices Award** — National award for community-facing work at the Valley Air District
- **Director of the Year (2024)** — awarded to top-performing director at Valley Air District
- **Certified Professional Facilitator** — experienced moderating executive and multi-stakeholder sessions
- **Drum Major, UCLA Marching Band (2010–2012)** — led 250-member ensemble before 80,000+ audiences

THE FUN STUFF

- **Military Spouse-turned-Pilot Wife** — I know how to navigate new communities
- **Marathon Runner** — Striving (and striding) to qualify for Boston, but prefer trail running anyway.
- **Fashionably Early** — Being late makes me anxious.